L3 LEA · S5 · S6  ALICE MICHEL

*Anglais économique et commercial*

# Business English: an explained workbook

VERSION EXPRESS · UN EXERCICE D'APPLICATION PAR CHAPITRE

4 · 4 EXERCISES

Exercices rédigés pour l'application à partir des fiches du cours ; les situations marquées « fictive » sont inventées. En cas de différence avec le cours de l'enseignant, c'est le cours qui fait foi.

PART 1

## Business correspondence: letters and e-mails

**EXERCISE 1.1** APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

### Writing an enquiry to a foreign supplier

***Objective :*** *Write a complete, concise enquiry that asks for all the information needed to compare suppliers.*

You work for Orléans Gourmet SARL, a chain of 12 delicatessens in the Centre-Val de Loire region. At a food trade fair in London you visited the stand of Highland Shortbread Co., a Scottish biscuit maker; you do not know the name of their export manager. Write a letter asking for their export price list, terms of payment and delivery, the delivery time to Orléans, whether they offer quantity discounts, and some samples. Mention that you may place a substantial order before Christmas if their prices are competitive.

**Questions**

1. Write the plan of the letter (one line per step).
2. Write the full letter (salutation, subject line, body, close, signature).

PART 2

## Business vocabulary in context

**EXERCISE 2.1** APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

### Following an export transaction: vocabulary in context

***Objective :*** *Use the vocabulary of the company, finance and international trade in a realistic text.*

Complete the text with the following words (one use each): subsidiary, turnover, board, freight forwarder, bill of lading, consignee, customs clearance, letter of credit, market share, packing list. Text: 'Loire Valves SAS, a (1) ..... of a German group, achieved a (2) ..... of 35 million euros last year, 60% of it abroad. Its managing director reports to the group's (3) ..... . To increase its (4) ..... in Asia, the company has just sold 2,000 valves to a distributor in Singapore, who is the (5) ..... of the goods. The valves will be shipped by sea from Le Havre. Our (6) ..... will organise the transport and send the customer a copy of the (7) ....., the document issued by the shipping line, together with the commercial invoice and the (8) ....., which lists the contents of each case. Payment will be made by irrevocable (9) ..... . On arrival, the distributor's customs broker will handle (10) ..... .'

**Questions**

1. Complete the text.
2. Give the French equivalent of each word you used.
3. Which document would replace the bill of lading if the valves were sent by air?

PART 3

## Reading and summarising the business press

**EXERCISE 3.1** APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

### Writing a synthesis of two short articles

***Objective :*** *Compare two documents and write an objective synthesis in your own words with precise reporting verbs.*

Document 1 (fictional, a business magazine): 'A growing number of European manufacturers are moving production closer to home. A French furniture maker recently transferred part of its assembly from Asia to Eastern Europe in order to secure its supply chain and cut delivery times. The move has created several hundred jobs in the region, the company says.' Document 2 (fictional, a financial daily): 'Nearshoring is not a free lunch. Labour costs in Eastern Europe are rising fast, and some analysts warn that firms bringing production closer to home may lose competitiveness. Supply chains may be more secure, but consumers could end up paying higher prices.' Write a synthesis of about 80 to 100 words.

**Questions**

1. Note the main idea of each document.
2. Write the synthesis.
3. Underline the reporting verbs and connectors you used and explain the nuance of 'warn'.

PART 4

## Useful grammar for business English

**EXERCISE 4.1** APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

### Correcting an e-mail: tenses and conditionals

***Objective :*** *Apply the rules of present perfect, simple past and conditionals to a real business e-mail.*

A French assistant has written this e-mail to a British supplier. It contains six grammar mistakes (numbered). 'Dear Mr Lee, We (1) work with your company since 2019 and we (2) have always been satisfied with your service. However, last week we (3) have received order No. 552 with two cartons missing. (4) If you will send them by Friday, we will not need to cancel the order. (5) If we would have known about the problem earlier, we would have informed our own customer. In spite of this, sales of your products (6) increased this year, and we hope to continue our cooperation. Best regards, Julie Moreau'

**Questions**

1. Correct each numbered item (or say that it is correct) and state the rule.
2. Rewrite sentence (4) with 'Should you…' and sentence (4) with 'unless'.

# Explained answer key

## Exercise 1.1 · Writing an enquiry to a foreign supplier

1. 1. Source: we visited your stand at the London food fair. Introduction: chain of 12 delicatessens in central France. Request: export price list, terms of payment and delivery. Details: delivery time to Orléans, quantity discounts, samples. Prospect: substantial order before Christmas if prices are competitive. Conclusion: we look forward to hearing from you.
2. 2. Model letter: Dear Sir or Madam, / Re: Export price list and terms / We visited your stand at the recent food trade fair in London and were impressed by your range of shortbread. / We are a chain of 12 delicatessens based in the Centre-Val de Loire region of France. / Could you please send us your current export price list, together with details of your terms of payment and delivery? We would also like to know your delivery time to Orléans and whether you offer quantity discounts. In addition, we would be grateful if you could send us some samples. / If your prices are competitive, we may place a substantial order before Christmas. / We look forward to hearing from you. / Yours faithfully, / [Name], Purchasing Assistant, Orléans Gourmet SARL.
3. Why it works: the source of the contact shows the supplier how you know them; the introduction tells them what kind of customer you are; each request is precise, so the reply (a quotation) can be complete; the prospect of an order motivates a quick answer; an enquiry does not commit you to buy.
4. Final result: a concise letter in six short paragraphs, with 'Dear Sir or Madam' and 'Yours faithfully'.

**Traps to avoid :** Writing 'We order…': an enquiry is not an order and does not commit the buyer. · Forgetting to mention the destination (Orléans), without which the supplier cannot quote a delivery time. · Using 'inquiry' in a British context: 'enquiry' is the British spelling.

## Exercise 2.1 · Following an export transaction: vocabulary in context

1. 1. (1) subsidiary (a company controlled by the German group); (2) turnover (total sales, British usage); (3) board (board of directors); (4) market share; (5) consignee (the person the goods are delivered to); (6) freight forwarder (organises transport on behalf of the shipper); (7) bill of lading (the sea transport document issued by the shipping line); (8) packing list; (9) letter of credit; (10) customs clearance.
2. 2. subsidiary = filiale; turnover = chiffre d'affaires; board = conseil d'administration; market share = part de marché; consignee = destinataire; freight forwarder = transitaire; bill of lading = connaissement; packing list = liste de colisage; letter of credit = crédit documentaire; customs clearance = dédouanement.
3. 3. The air waybill (AWB), the transport document for air freight.
4. Final result: subsidiary, turnover, board, market share, consignee, freight forwarder, bill of lading, packing list, letter of credit, customs clearance.

**Traps to avoid :** Confusing shipper (the sender of the goods) and consignee (the receiver). · Confusing turnover (sales) with staff turnover (rotation du personnel). · Confusing freight forwarder (organiser) and carrier (the company that actually transports).

## Exercise 3.1 · Writing a synthesis of two short articles

1. 1. Document 1: nearshoring brings benefits (secure supply chain, shorter delivery times, jobs). Document 2: nearshoring has costs (rising wages, lower competitiveness, higher prices).
2. 2. Model (about 90 words): The two documents deal with nearshoring, the trend for European manufacturers to bring production closer to home. Both point out that firms relocate to secure their supply chains. However, while the first document highlights the benefits of such a move, such as shorter delivery times and job creation in Eastern Europe, the second warns that labour costs there are rising quickly, which may reduce competitiveness. It adds that consumers could ultimately face higher prices. All in all, the documents show that nearshoring improves security but may come at a cost.
3. 3. Reporting verbs: point out (draw attention to a fact both documents share), highlight (stress a positive aspect), warn (announce a risk: it signals that the author is presenting a possible danger), adds. Connectors: Both, However, while, All in all. The synthesis contains no personal opinion.
4. Final result: an objective, comparative text organised by theme, with an introductory sentence and a neutral conclusion.

**Traps to avoid :** Summarising document 1, then document 2, without comparing them. · Copying sentences such as 'Nearshoring is not a free lunch'. · Adding 'I think that…' in a synthesis.

## Exercise 4.1 · Correcting an e-mail: tenses and conditionals

1. 1. (1) 'have worked' (or 'have been working') with your company since 2019: 'since' + a duration that continues requires the present perfect, unlike the French present ('nous travaillons depuis'). (2) Correct: 'have always been satisfied' is a review up to now, so the present perfect is right. (3) 'received': 'last week' places the action in a finished, dated past, so the simple past is required. (4) 'If you send them by Friday, we will not need…': type 1, no 'will' in the if-clause. (5) 'If we had known about the problem earlier, we would have informed…': type 3 (unreal past) = if + past perfect, would have + past participle; 'would' is not used in the if-clause. (6) 'have increased': 'this year' is a current period, so the present perfect is used ('increased last year' would be correct with a finished period).
2. 2. 'Should you send them by Friday, we will not need to cancel the order.' (elegant replacement for 'if you send'). 'Unless you send them by Friday, we will need to cancel the order.' ('unless' = except if: the logic becomes negative, so the main clause changes too).
3. Final result: have worked, have always been (correct), received, If you send, If we had known, have increased.

**Traps to avoid :** Translating 'depuis' + present by the English present ('we work since 2019'). · Using the present perfect with 'last week', 'yesterday', 'ago'. · Putting 'will' or 'would' after 'if'.

*Ouverture du journal…*